

Synectics

Use deliberately unusual analogies to loosen fixed thinking and generate new ways to understand or solve a problem.

CONCEPT / PROBLEM

NAME

STARTING CONCEPT OR PROBLEM

DIRECT ANALOGY

What unrelated thing works in a similar way?

PERSONAL ANALOGY

If you were inside the problem, what would you feel, want, or do?

SYMBOLIC ANALOGY

What short image, contradiction, or metaphor captures its essence?

FANTASY ANALOGY

If normal limits vanished, what impossible solution or version could exist?

RETURN TO THE REAL PROBLEM: Which analogy gives you a useful new idea?
